QM47400 · Spring 2027 · Milestone 11

Poster Presentation Planning

DUE	**Sunday, April 11, 2027, 11:59 PM ET**
OPENS	Sunday, April 4, 2027
SUBMIT	One PDF per group, uploaded by one member: `NN_presentation_planning.pdf`
GRADING	Rubric: pitches 30%, fit to the audience 20%, poster integration 20%, question strategy 15%, cohesion and professionalism 15%

What this milestone is for

At the conference on Tuesday, April 13, the poster is printed and the conversation is up to you. People will stop for thirty seconds or for five minutes, and some will know your field while others will not. This milestone is your plan for those conversations: who you will talk to, what you will say at three lengths, how you will use the poster as you talk, and how you will invite and ask questions.

What to do

Write a short plan with four parts.

1. **Your audience.** One paragraph on who is likely to stop at your poster (classmates, domain experts, the general public) and the two or three points that will resonate with them, such as career relevance, social impact or technical novelty.
2. **Three elevator pitches,** written out as scripts:
   - a **30-second pitch**, at most 75 words, that grabs attention: your title, your main question and why it matters;
   - a **90-second pitch**, at most 200 words, that adds your method in brief, your key results, and why they matter;
   - a **2-minute pitch**, at most 300 words, with the full arc: introduction, method, results, interpretation and next steps, plus a real-world application.
3. **Poster integration.** Where on the poster you will point to key charts or tables, method steps and conclusions, and a short bullet outline of how you move from one section of the poster to the next.
4. **Questions and discussion.** When and how you will invite questions (for example, *"Do you see other potential applications?"*), and at least three questions you will ask your audience to get them thinking or making connections.

What to submit

One member uploads `NN_presentation_planning.pdf` for the whole group, with the four parts in order: the audience paragraph, the three pitch scripts, the poster outline, and the question strategy.

How it is graded

By the rubric's weights: the clarity and concision of the pitches (30%), how well they fit the audience you identified (20%), how effectively you use the poster (20%), the creativity and thoroughness of your question strategy (15%), and the cohesion and professionalism of the whole plan (15%).

Tips

- Build every pitch around your cross-validated headline result and your champion, in your stakeholder's terms.
- Count the words. A pitch over its limit is a pitch that runs long at the poster.
- Rehearse aloud, with a timer, before the conference.

The Final Project Overview PDF has every date, the meeting rounds, and how the project is graded.